

Vehicle Databases (VDB) — Data Services Utilization Summary

Prepared for: Yassin, Abubeckr • OtoPair • 7 July 2026

Purpose: Reference for the VDB renewal / renegotiation discussion. Sets out the VDB services OtoPair actively relies on, and the services it does not use, with the business rationale for each.

OtoPair integrates Vehicle Databases as its primary source of structured vehicle data. VDB underpins several core, customer-facing functions that no free data source can support. The value OtoPair draws from VDB is concentrated in vehicle imagery, the trim catalog, and vehicle specifications — data the public NHTSA database does not provide.

1. VDB services OtoPair actively uses

Service	What it provides	Business function it supports
Vehicle Imagery & Paint Colors	High-quality vehicle images and factory paint-color options.	Sole source for the hero vehicle image and the onboarding paint-color picker. NHTSA provides no imagery, so this is irreplaceable.
Trim Catalog (YMMT)	Canonical, image-compatible Year / Make / Model / Trim listings.	Powers the trim picker during onboarding. NHTSA does not expose usable trim names, so VDB is required here.
Vehicle Specifications (VIN decode)	Engine code & displacement, transmission type/speeds, engine output (horsepower), EPA fuel economy (city/highway/combined MPG), battery cold-cranking amps (CCA), and OEM brake tier (standard / sport / carbon-ceramic).	Builds each vehicle's spec profile and the spec card shown at onboarding; the brake tier pre-selects the rotor booking. MPG is a VDB-exclusive value.

2. VDB services OtoPair does not use — and why

Service	Status	Business reason
Tire Specifications (sizes, pressures)	Not used	OtoPair sources OEM tire data — sizes, pressures, load/speed ratings, and the full factory fitment list — from a specialist wheel/tire data provider.
Repair Estimates — Labor Times	Not relied upon	VDB labor times enter only as a near-zero-weight tiebreaker; OtoPair's quoted labor comes from flat-rate and other labor providers better aligned to its marketplace pricing.
Repair Estimates — Parts Pricing	Not used	VDB cost fields are never read. Live parts pricing is sourced from OEM-parts retailers, as VDB's pricing does not reflect current market rates.

Service	Status	Business reason
Repair Estimates — Maintenance Schedules (service intervals)	Minimal use	VDB's mileage schedules are ingested as one input, but OtoPair's maintenance tracker runs primarily on its own default and per-make interval tables. In practice VDB contributes only the oil-change mileage on some VIN-decoded vehicles — tire, battery and inspection cadences never come from VDB.
Basic Vehicle Identity (make/model/year, cylinder count, fuel type)	Not used from VDB	These fields are available at no cost from the public NHTSA database, which OtoPair uses as the source (and as the tie-breaker on vehicle identity).

Net effect: OtoPair uses very little of VDB's Repair Estimates product — not its labor times, not its parts pricing, and only marginally its maintenance schedules (the tracker is driven primarily by OtoPair's own interval tables).

3. Operational points to confirm with VDB

Point	Detail
Trim catalog access	Confirm the YMMT / ymm-specs option endpoints are active on the current plan. This access is account-gated and can be disabled per-account; when it is, the trim-selection experience degrades silently during onboarding.
Usage & metering	Each vehicle onboarding generates multiple lookups (specifications, imagery, colors, and trim). Confirm the plan's rate limits and metering align with expected onboarding volume.

Every statement in this summary was verified against OtoPair's production code on 7 July 2026.